Minutes of the
Mid-MO Amateur Radio Club, Inc.
Jefferson City, MO

Meeting of: March 8, 2012

Called to order by: President, Rich Kreiser, NØJBF

In attendance: ACØSA – Richard Manning; N8PZT – Stephen Brown; K9ZTV – Kent Trimble; KBØQHZ – Joe Betros; KCØPET – Rick Bennett; KDØDSJ – Randall Rolle; KDØFAS – Roger Conway; KDØGRM – Stephen Hick; KDØNJU – Mac Kennedy; KDØMRJ – Bill Anderson; KDØQFN – Mike Betros; KDØQPC – Chris Byrd; KIØY – Mark Eberle; KMØS – Mike Thayer; NØJBF – Richard Kreiser; NØTKN – Jim Biggerstaff; NMØC – Nancie McAnaugh; WA2KBZ – Karl Schulte; W4RK – Bill Gerth; WØQBX – J. Gattermeir; WØXII - Bob Heald; WAØZOG – Mike Miller; WBØAQV – Greg Abbott; WNØI – Andy Adams; Evan Hemeyer

Previous Meeting Minutes (presented & approved as submitted):

Secretary-Treasurer's Report:

Previous Bank Balance:	$17,901.69
Electric Bill	- $9.89
Phone Bill	- $35.92
Current Bank Balance:	$17,855.88

Old business

2-Meter Net Report: Mike, NØZH, reported a total of 79 check-ins in January.

Net Results:

Feb 15	KDØGRM	18
Feb 22	KDØQFN	14
Feb 29	KDØPET	23
Mar 7	NØZH	

Upcoming Net Controllers:

Mar 14	KDØGRM
Mar 21	KDØQFN
Mar 28	KBØQHZ
Apr 4	NØJBF
Apr 11	KDØQFN

Please contact Mike at [REDACTED] or by phone at [REDACTED], if you will not be able to call the net you are scheduled for so other arrangements can be made.

2-Meter Repeater report: Jim, NØTKN, reported that the repeater is functioning. The phone line has been repaired and the autopatch now functions correctly. Before purchasing a new battery Jim took a known good battery to the repeater site and hooked it up. The test revealed that during a power failure, the repeater would reset itself upon changeover to battery power. So simply purchasing a battery and installing it will not solve the reset issue. Also, the repeater will not charge the battery.

Methods to solve these issues were investigated and included: Option A – Purchase an Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) to keep the repeater powered up during short power outages. While this will keep the repeater from resetting, it would only be useful for short durations before shutting down. Price: around $300. Option B – Purchase the new battery system which would help keep power available for longer durations (up to a couple days), but still have the annoying reset issue. Price: around $500-600. And finally, Option C – purchase both the UPS and a new battery system to be used in conjunction. Price: around $900.

Joe, KBØQHZ, moved that the club pursue Option C and Bill, W4RK, seconded. A short discussion took place and the motion passed.

Digipeater report: Rick, KCØPET, reported that the new Kantronics KPC-3+ TNC has been received and is up and running. The hardware installation went quickly, but the programming took a little while. This new TNC has many more programming options and adds new features such as the capability to remotely change the settings. Once Rick has had a little more time to tinker with the settings, it will be placed back at the permanent site.

Missouri Emergency Packet Network (MEPN): Jim, NØTKN, reported that the network was functioning. The Intertie is now functional as well.

Local Emergency Coordinator's report: Rich, NØJBF, reported that he needs to get in touch with Kevin Wieberg in regards to the ID badges.

Mike, NØZH, has been working with the Red Cross about getting an antenna raised for 40M and 80M in addition to raising the J-pole antenna to a higher location. More info on this work day will follow.

District Emergency Coordinator's report: Joe, KBØQHZ, reported that things have been quiet on the district side.

VE Liaison's report: Nancie, NMØC, reported that there are two tests to be administered after the meeting. New VE's should consider helping.

CW Classes: Kent, K9ZTV, reported that the classes are continuing.

The advanced class meets at Mel's Country Café at 6:45am on Saturday mornings. The beginning class meets at Mel's after breakfast on Saturday mornings at 9am.

Training Committee: Mike, KMØS, reported that an Extra class upgrade session will begin later in March or the first part of April. An email will be sent out with details. A manual currently runs about $29.

Mike also attended a faith-based disaster workshop. At the end of the session, Mike was able to put in a plug for amateur radio and mentioned if anyone was interested in attending licensing classes to contact him.

Club Shirts/Jackets/Patches: No report.

Mid-Mo Emergency Radio Service: Rich, NØJBF, reported that Jerry supplied some additional material on a writing mission statement and a first year's budget.

Field Day: Rich, NØJBF, reported on Mike's behalf that the vehicles have been secured including the MoDOT trailer and Don Atkinson's camper. The Red Cross van is still looking like a good possibility. The Jefferson City Fire Department has a trailer that may be available as well. Rich will pass the contact along to Mike.

New business

Titanic Special Event station: Kent, K9ZTV, reported that the Nixa radio club has asked the MMARC to head the CW station for the 100th anniversary operation this year. Kent accepted this invite and contacted 8-10 people about operating. There are 4-5 confirmed participants, but everyone is encouraged to come operate the station whether on CW or SSB. The event will take place April 13th, 14th, and 15th.

Announcements:

Rick, KCØPET, announced that Ozarkcon will be held on April 14th and 15th.

Greg, WBØAQV, announced that he is looking for commercial radio equipment.

Presentation:

None.

Respectfully submitted: Mark Eberle (KIØY), Secretary-Treasurer.

Visit the MMARC web page at: http://www.mmccs.com/mmarc